Abdullah Al Zahid

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Talent Acquisition
SYSTRA Canada, Toronto, ON

Re: GIS Manager, GO Expansion Program

Dear Hiring Manager,

I would like to apply for one of the two GIS Manager positions supporting the GO Expansion Program. I worked at Metrolinx in 2023 as a Transportation Planner in Service Design, on the GO network the program is expanding, and since January 2024 I have been an Assistant Planner in Transportation Planning at the City of Toronto, where much of my work is building and maintaining the spatial data the division relies on.

At the City I build and maintain the road and right-of-way datasets Transportation Planning depends on, using GIS and Python, including a right-of-way width dataset covering all city roads, built with QGIS, MapBox and JavaScript. I also built the Transportation Data Dashboard, which combined several years of Transportation Tomorrow Survey data into one validated source the division now reports from. Looking for the places where automation and better data could replace manual work is how I approach a dataset.

At Metrolinx I ran OpenTrack simulations of GO rail services to test how infrastructure constraints and speed restrictions changed run times and reliability, and presented that evidence to schedulers, operations staff and engineers. I also set up a command line workflow that pre-simulated slow orders in batches, cutting turnaround on scenario requests from days to hours, and built the Crew Variance Tool, a Python application that read large JSON operations files and summarised speed profiles and run-time variance across subdivisions.

I should be straightforward about the gaps. I have not administered ArcGIS Enterprise, or set an enterprise GIS roadmap, governance framework or data standards, and I have not managed GIS staff, budgets or vendors. Of the tools listed, I work in ArcGIS Pro, Python and SQL, but I have not used FME, Arcade, Field Maps, Survey123, Jira or Power BI. I am applying because the data integration and automation at the centre of the role is the work I do now, and I know the network it serves.

Thank you for considering my application.

Sincerely,

Abdullah Al Zahid

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